



Fire safety in the home

Overview

Fire safety in the home comprises a set of five units; *Fire safety in the home*, *Make your home safe*, *Bedtime safety checks*, *Fire!* and *Fire safety in the home - research and revision*. These units aim to support learners in developing the language, knowledge and understanding to:

- recognise common causes of fires
- make their homes as safe as possible
- know what action to take if there is a fire and use 999 to call for the fire service if necessary.

Level: Each set of resources includes:

- activities for beginner reader writers
- activities at Entry 1 (Access 2 in Scotland)
- differentiated activities for learners at Entry 2/ Entry 3 (Access 3/Intermediate level 1 in Scotland) or higher
- ideas for extension activities

Learning hours and delivery context:

The five *Fire safety in the home* units provide a minimum of 7.5 hours of learning in a classroom context. These units can be used independently or as one linked topic over four or more sessions. If you are going to use more than unit, use them in the order provided. Timings are flexible and teachers can break the units into smaller chunks of learning and build in differentiation, revision and extension activities as required.

The resource is suitable for use in a wide range of adult ESOL learning contexts including community ESOL and FE. Additionally, the teacher notes provide suggestions on how practitioners can develop further linked learning (such as developing and working with learner-produced texts) and build links with the local fire service to further develop and support learners' skills, knowledge and confidence.

Preparation

Fire safety in the home units comprise:

1. Activities and worksheets to download and print. Key words matching sheets can be printed off, laminated and cut up to make matching activities or for learners to play pelmanism. Alternatively learners can draw lines to match the words and pictures. Key words answer sheets can be used to check answers and for beginner readers writers to recognise, read and say each key word then write over the grey version of each word and copy independently on the dotted lines.
2. On-line interactive activities which need a computer with data projector and audio speakers – these can be done independently or in pairs if there are enough computers, or projected onto the screen and done as a whole class activity
3. *Fire safety* leaflets - you can ask learners to view these on line, request copies from your local fire service or download from www.directgov.uk. The main leaflet to support activities in these units is: **Fire – make your home safe** leaflet (Entry 1+):

http://www.direct.gov.uk/prod_consum_dg/groups/dg_digitalassets/@dg/@en/documents/digitalasset/dg_182673.pdf



For additional reading and research, learners with (Entry 2+/Access 3+) English can read the **Fire safety in the home** leaflet:

http://www.direct.gov.uk/en/groups/dg_digitalassets/@dg/@en/documents/digitalasset/dg_073993.pdf

Entry 2+/Access 3+ learners who live in shared or rented accommodation, can also read the **Fire safety in shared or rented accommodation** leaflet: http://www.direct.gov.uk/en/groups/dg_digitalassets/@dg/@en/documents/digitalasset/dg_074034.pdf

You can also:

- collect images or newspaper stories relating to fire safety in the home
- get further information from the website for the fire service in your area, e.g. <http://www.london-fire.gov.uk/SafetyAtHome.asp>
- take a smoke alarm into the class. In some areas it is possible to request one from the local fire service
- contact your local fire service and ask if they are able to visit the centre and meet learners. Local fire services are often keen to have opportunities to meet people from the local community in order to raise awareness about fire safety. In some areas they will have forms for local residents to fill in and return requesting a fire safety visit to their homes and for a free smoke alarm to be fitted. Your local fire service may have a community liaison person who can help to arrange this.

Unit 2: Make your home safe

Time: approximately 1.5 hours

Aims:

- To support learners in developing the language, knowledge and understanding to make their homes safe

Objectives:

By the end of this session, all learners will:

- Identify some actions to make their homes safe
- Give short safety instructions

In addition, beginner reader writers will:

- Read, copy and write some key words and short sentences about fire safety in the home

Confident Entry1/Entry 2/Access 3 + learners will:

- Read and discuss a short simple text about common causes of fires in the home
- Complete and write some instructions about fire safety in the home.

Suggested procedure

1. Set the context (all levels)

- Elicit some of the causes of fires identified in *Unit 1: Fire safety in the home*.
- Choose a few of the examples and ask learners to change the danger into an instruction for action people can take to make their homes safe, e.g.
 - *The smoke alarm batteries are flat.*
can change to
 - *Test the smoke alarm. Or Change the smoke alarm batteries.*
- Explain to learners they are going to practise more instructions for making their homes safe.

2. Make your home safe research

- Begin by asking the following questions and/or writing them on the board:

- *What can you do to make your home safe?:*
- *What can you buy?*
- *What can you do in the kitchen?*
- *What about electric plugs?*
- *What about cigarettes and candles?*

Beginner reader writers:

- Elicit possible answers to the questions.
- Give out images from Unit 2 key words. Elicit/ present, model and drill each word.
- Learners can then work in pairs to match the words on the worksheet and check their answers.
- Learners can then copy directly onto each word in grey tone before copying onto the dotted lines.

For learners who can read and understand short simple sentences:

- Use some different DARTS¹ activities with learners to support them in engaging with **Fire – make your home safe** leaflet
http://www.direct.gov.uk/prod_consum_dg/groups/dg_digitalassets/@dg/@en/documents/digitalasset/dg_182673.pdf according to their level, for example,

If you have a data projector:

- Project pages 2 – 14 of **Fire – make your home safe** onto the whiteboard. Scroll through and ask learners to say stop when you are projecting page which might answer any of the questions. Quickly elicit the answers to the questions in this way.
- Now go back to page 2 and go through the pages again more slowly. For each page, ask concept questions and elicit statements from the learners based on the image.

¹ DARTS = Directed activities relating to text (see <http://www.teachingenglish.org.uk/articles/interacting-texts-directed-activities-related-texts-darts>)

- Depending on their level, learners can read identified words or sentences aloud together or in turns.

If you don't have a data projector, or as a follow up activity:

- Ask learners to quickly scan pages 2 – 14 of **Fire – make your home safe** leaflet together in pairs to find the answers to the questions.
- Check answers together.
- Now ask learners to go back to page 2 and go through the pages 2 – 14 more slowly. Depending on their level, learners can read identified words or sentences aloud together or in turns. Ask them to highlight any new words.
- When learners have had time to read the pages together, elicit highlighted words onto the whiteboard
- Ask concept questions and elicit statements from the learners based on the text.

3. **Make your home safe**

For beginner reader writers:

- Give out a selection of images based on the previous activities and support learners to compose short simple sentences about making homes safe
- Read out some example instructions and ask learners to hold up an image card if it is relevant to the statement.
- Use image cards to elicit back some of the key instructions. Model and drill these sentences.
- Ask learners to choose one or two instructions that they want to follow up at home. Learners can copy key words or the whole sentence relating to these instructions.

For learners who can read and write short simple sentences:

- Divide learners into pairs and give out *Make your home safe* worksheet
- Explain task to learners and that they can choose to make the activity more difficult if they want to by:
 - looking at the missing words and folding over the paper on the dotted lines so they cannot see them
 - folding over the paper on the dotted lines without looking at the missing words

- Give out *Make your home safe- answers*. Ask learners to check their answers individually or in pairs.

4. Recap

- Use realia and/or images to check learning and revise key words.
- Have a whole group discussion about what learners are going to do to make their homes safer.

2. Extension activity

- In the following class, ask learners to report back on any action they have taken. Use this as an opportunity to revise/practise the past simple tense, e.g.

I bought a smoke alarm.

I checked the batteries in my smoke alarm.

I checked all my extension leads.